SPOOKY TUNES

PACING

Pacing guide · 6 days (1 learning / 3 work / 2 finish + present)

Teacher

Six class periods of about 53 minutes: one learning day, three work days, then finishing and presenting. Each day's full plan is on pages 7–9.

DAY	FOCUS AND GOAL	MINUTE BLOCKS	SHOW / USE
DAY 1 Learning	**Space is a sound: the bus demo** Every student has a working reverb bus by the end of class. Delay bus setup begins on Day 2.	0–5 · The video 5–15 · Intro deck 15–35 · Bus demo 35–50 · Reverb bus 50–53 · Exit check	Intro deck slides 1–9
DAY 2 Work day	**Delay bus, keys, sounds** Both buses working, two minor keys chosen, at least 5 sounds imported.	0–10 · Watch again 10–22 · Delay bus 22–30 · Two minor keys 30–53 · Sound exploration	Slides 10–11, key map, cue sheet
DAY 3 Work day	**Experiment, then start scoring** First draft started: the video imported, markers placed, at least half the video (measures 1–16) scored in key 1.	0–5 · Near or far? 5–15 · Video + markers 15–50 · Experiment + compose 50–53 · Check-in	Slide 11, worked example
DAY 4 Work day	**Composition: the key change** Full video scored, key 2 in place from measure 17, rough mix in place.	0–5 · The key change 5–48 · Compose 48–53 · Rough mix	Project sheet
DAY 5 Finish + present	**Mix, reflect, submit** All projects submitted with a reflection. Early presentations if time allows.	0–30 · Final mix 30–37 · Reflection 37–43 · Export + submit 43–53 · Early presentations	Checklist + rubric
DAY 6 Presenting	**Watch and listen together** Every student plays their score with the video and explains one sound.	0–5 · Feedback questions 5–50 · Presentations 50–53 · Close	Rubric

STUDENT PAGES BY DAY ·

Day 1	Day 1 post (p. 14), How to Bus (pp. 19–20)
Day 2	How to Bus Part 2 (p. 21), Minor Key Map (p. 23), reference card (p. 24), cue sheet (p. 25), project sheet (pp. 15–17)
Days 3–4	Project sheet steps 4–5, troubleshooting (p. 22), vocabulary (p. 26)
Day 5	Tips and reflection (p. 18), submission checklist (p. 27)
Day 6	Rubric for self-score and teacher score (p. 28)

PREVIEW

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SPOOKY TUNES

Project sheet · requirements and sound sources

STUDENT

REQUIREMENTS ·

- [ ] Reverb bus set up correctly in Logic: aux channel, Bus 1, Space Designer at 100% wet
- [ ] Delay bus set up correctly in Logic: aux channel, Bus 2, Tape Delay or Echo at 100% wet
- [ ] At least 3 tracks sending to the reverb bus
- [ ] At least 1 track sending to the delay bus
- [ ] Two different minor keys: key 1 for measures 1–16, key 2 for measures 17–32 (atonal sound effects can sit on top)
- [ ] Minimum 5 distinct sound sources (a combination of the Logic library, your own recording, and a free download)
- [ ] At least 1 original recording made with a microphone
- [ ] At least 1 sound downloaded from a free sound-effects site (such as pixabay.com) and imported into Logic
- [ ] Music composed to the full length of the video: 32 measures, about 1 minute
- [ ] No empty silence longer than 5 seconds unless it is a deliberate compositional choice
- [ ] Project named: Your Name – Spooky Tunes
- [ ] Exported as MP3 and .zip (compressed .logicx file) and submitted to your class page before presenting
- [ ] A short written reflection: two specific techniques you used to create atmosphere, and why you chose them

SOUND SOURCES ·

You have three places to find sounds for this project. Use all three.

Logic Pro library	Open the Loop Browser (O) or the Library. Search by keyword: try “dark”, “tension”, “drone”, “cinematic”, “wind”, “impact”. You are not limited to loops: individual one-shots and samples work well for SFX layers.
Your own recording	Record your own sounds in the room. Scratch a surface. Close a door slowly. Tap something hollow. Crumple paper. Hum. Any recorded sound can become something unsettling with enough processing. Drag the recording into Logic and apply effects.
A free download	Go to a free sound-effects site your teacher approves (for example pixabay.com › Sound Effects) and search for atmospheric or horror sounds. Download as MP3, then drag the file from your Downloads folder into the Tracks area to create a new audio track. Check the site’s license.

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PART 1 · SET UP YOUR REVERB BUS ·

Start from the track you want to add reverb to, not from a blank aux channel. Logic creates the bus automatically when you make the send.

1 OPEN THE CHANNEL STRIP FOR YOUR TRACK

In the Mixer (X) or the inspector on the left, find the channel strip for the track you want to add reverb to. Look for the Sends section: it sits below the insert plugin slots.

If you cannot see Sends, widen the inspector or the Mixer so the Sends slots show.

2 CLICK AN EMPTY SEND SLOT AND CHOOSE A BUS

In the Sends section, click one of the empty slots. A menu appears. Go to Bus and choose Bus 1 (any bus that shows no name next to it is empty).

Watch what happens: Logic automatically creates an Aux channel strip routed to that bus. You do not need to create it manually.

3 RAISE THE SEND LEVEL

A small knob now appears in the send slot. At its lowest, nothing is going to the bus. Click and drag it upward. Start around –15 dB.

This is the most critical step. A send knob at its lowest sends nothing. Nothing will happen until you raise it.

4 ADD SPACE DESIGNER TO THE AUX CHANNEL

Find the Aux channel Logic just created in the Mixer. Click its first empty Insert slot and choose Reverb › Space Designer. For Spooky Tunes, try a large hall, cathedral or other large-space preset.

The Aux channel may appear at the far right of the Mixer. Scroll if you cannot find it.

5 SET SPACE DESIGNER TO 100% WET

Inside Space Designer, set the Dry signal to 0% and the Wet signal to 100%. The bus outputs only the reverb. The dry signal always comes from the original track.

This is the most common mistake. If the plugin is partially dry, you hear the sound doubled. Always 100% wet on a bus plugin.

6 NAME THE AUX CHANNEL

Double-click the name at the bottom of the Aux channel strip and type REVERB BUS.

You only set this up once. Every other track that needs reverb just needs a send pointing to the same bus number.

7 SEND MORE TRACKS TO THE SAME BUS

Select another track. Click an empty Send slot. Choose the same bus number as before. Raise the send level. That track now shares the reverb.

Do not pick a new bus number for each track. All reverb sends point to the same bus.

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SPOOKY TUNES

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

Score each category from 2 to 5. Score yourself first, then your teacher scores.

Category	2	3	4	5	Self	Teacher
SOUND DESIGN & ATMOSPHERE	Fewer than 3 sound sources used. Sounds feel generic or unrelated to the visual. No sense of atmosphere.	At least 3 sound sources used but choices feel arbitrary. Some atmospheric quality but inconsistent.	At least 5 sound sources including an original recording and a free download. Sounds contribute to a consistent spooky atmosphere.	Sound choices are intentional and varied. The combination of sources creates a genuinely unsettling atmosphere that serves the video at every moment.		
COMPOSITION & PACING	Music does not respond to the video. Sounds placed arbitrarily. Long stretches of silence or constant unvarying noise. No clear minor key.	Some response to the video but key moments are missed or poorly timed. Music feels like it is playing alongside the video rather than for it. Two keys attempted, but the change is hard to hear.	Music responds to the video at most key moments. Energy builds and releases appropriately. No unintentional dead air. Two minor keys, and the change is clear.	Music serves the picture precisely. Key moments are acknowledged. Silence is used as a compositional tool. The move to the second minor key lands on a moment in the video. The piece feels like it was written for this specific video.		
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Bus routing not set up or set up incorrectly. Space Designer and Tape Delay not at 100% wet. Sends not used.	Bus routing partially correct. At least one bus working but setup has errors. Some sends used but inconsistently.	Both buses set up correctly. Sends used on multiple tracks. Wet/dry balance adjusted by ear.	Both buses set up correctly and used with intention. Send levels vary between tracks to create spatial depth. Workflow is organized and confident.		
REVERB & DELAY AS MIX	Effects not used to create space or depth. Everything either fully dry or drenched indiscriminately.	Effects present but applied uniformly. No sense of near/far or spatial relationship between elements.	Reverb and delay used to place sounds at different perceived distances. Mix has some sense of depth and space.	Effects used to create a convincing sense of physical space. Near elements are dry, distant elements are wet. Reverb and delay contribute to the atmosphere rather than just processing the sound.		
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Project not submitted or not presented.	Project submitted late or named incorrectly. Presentation made with minimal engagement.	Project named correctly and submitted. Presentation made. Feedback questions posted. Reflection written.	Project correctly named, submitted on time. Student presents with confidence and can explain their sound choices and how the effects serve the atmosphere. Three thoughtful feedback questions posted.		
				TOTAL	**/ 25**	**/ 25**

ONE SOUND I'M PROUD OF

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TEACHER COMMENTS

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PREVIEW